Jon Brodziak - NOAA Federal <jon.brodziak@noaa.gov>

Leadership Transition and Commitment to NOAA's Mission

1 message

Nancy Hann <announcement@noaa.gov> Wed, Feb 5, 2025 at 10:21 AM
Reply-To: NO-REPLY@noaa.gov
Bcc: bcast-noaa-all@noaa.gov

NOAA NATIONAL OCEANIC AND ATMOSPHERIC ADMINISTRATION
UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

February 5, 2025

Consistent with prior transitions, I have been asked to perform the duties of NOAA Administrator until the Senate confirms a permanent Administrator. I am honored to lead NOAA during this time, and I'm fully committed to ensuring continuity and support for your efforts to execute the NOAA mission.

I would first like to share a few personnel updates:

- Howard Lutnick had his Senate Commerce, Science and Transportation Committee confirmation hearing on January 29th, and the Committee approved his nomination on February 5th. The next step, a full Senate vote on confirmation, is expected soon.

- Neil Jacobs, who served as Assistant Secretary of Commerce for Environmental Observation and Prediction, and performed the duties of NOAA Administrator during the previous Trump Administration, has been nominated to serve as NOAA Administrator.

- Please join me in welcoming several new Trump Administration political appointees who have joined NOAA since the inauguration. They include:
    - Laura Grimm, NOAA Chief of Staff
    - Erik Noble, Deputy Assistant Secretary of Commerce for Oceans and Atmosphere
    - Juan Caro, Deputy Assistant Secretary for International Affairs
    - Keegan McLaughlin, Special Assistant, Office of the Under Secretary

- Several senior career NOAA employees have taken on departed political appointees' responsibilities, while also continuing in their current roles, until permanent Trump Administration political appointees arrive. As new political appointees come aboard to fill these positions, the NOAA Organization Chart will be updated to reflect changes:
    - Dr. Stephen Volz, Assistant Administrator for NOAA Satellites, is serving as Acting Assistant Secretary for Environmental Observation and Prediction;
    - Emily Menashes, Deputy Assistant Administrator for NOAA Fisheries, is performing the duties of Assistant Secretary for Oceans and Atmosphere and Acting Assistant Administrator for NOAA Fisheries;

- Dr. Steve Thur, Assistant Administrator for NOAA Research, is serving as Acting Chief Scientist;
- Alexa Cole, Director, Office of International Affairs, NMFS, is serving as Deputy Assistant Secretary for International Fisheries;
- Meredith Cameron, Chief of Staff of the Office of Legislative and Intergovernmental Affairs, is serving as Acting Director of the Office of Legislative and Intergovernmental Affairs;
- Scott Smullen, Deputy Director for the Office of Communications, is serving as Acting Director of the Office of Communications; and
- Jeff Dillen and Kristen Gustafson, Deputy General Counsels, are co-serving as Acting General Counsel.

- There have been several recent Executive Orders and Actions which apply to NOAA. We are working with the Department and White House to fully understand and comply with these directives. In addition, each employee (other than uniformed service) received an offer to resign/retire. Further information is available on the OPM website here.

I'm deeply saddened by the recent aviation tragedy in Washington, D.C. My heart goes out to the victims, their families, and everyone affected by this devastating event. NOAA's swift response—providing critical weather forecasts and decision support to our partners at the FAA, NTSB, and USCG—is one example of the unwavering dedication of our workforce to serve the American people. The Department of Commerce's Employee Assistance Program offers confidential support and resources for employees impacted by this and other recent tragedies.

Since assuming the role of Deputy Under Secretary for Operations, I've appreciated the opportunity to see the passion, values, and brilliance of the people who carry out NOAA's mission of Science, Service, and Stewardship. I look forward to continuing to work with you, and to introducing the new Administration to our incredible workforce and mission.

Sincerely,

Vice Admiral Nancy Hann
Deputy Under Secretary for Operations
Performing the Duties of Under Secretary
of Commerce for Oceans and Atmosphere
and NOAA Administrator